MODULE 18

Adult Content-Related Crime Investigation

Certified Cyber Criminologist - Police / LEA Training

Samir Raja (CYBER07) | Cyber Crime Investigator & Offensive Security Researcher

What You Will Learn

Private images spread without permission, fake images made to defame, blackmail through such content - **one perspective only: the victim's justice**.

- Winning the **victim's trust** and guarding her dignity
- IT Act **66E, 67, 67A**, BNS **77**, and **POCSO** where children are involved
- Filing on **cybercrime.gov.in** - including anonymous reporting
- The **hash and timestamp method** - evidence without viewing or sharing
- A one-page **support handout** every station should keep ready

One Perspective Only

This chapter looks at these crimes from **one side alone**: how to help the victim, what the law gives, how the investigation moves.

- We do not study the criminal's methods here - **our goal is her justice**
- The deepest hurt falls on the victim - **shame, fear, loneliness**
- In every line of this module, **her dignity comes first**
- Staying silent helps the criminal. **Complaining is courage** - teach every victim that

First Step: Winning Her Trust

She arrives scared and broken, expecting blame. **Your first job is to prove the system is on her side.**

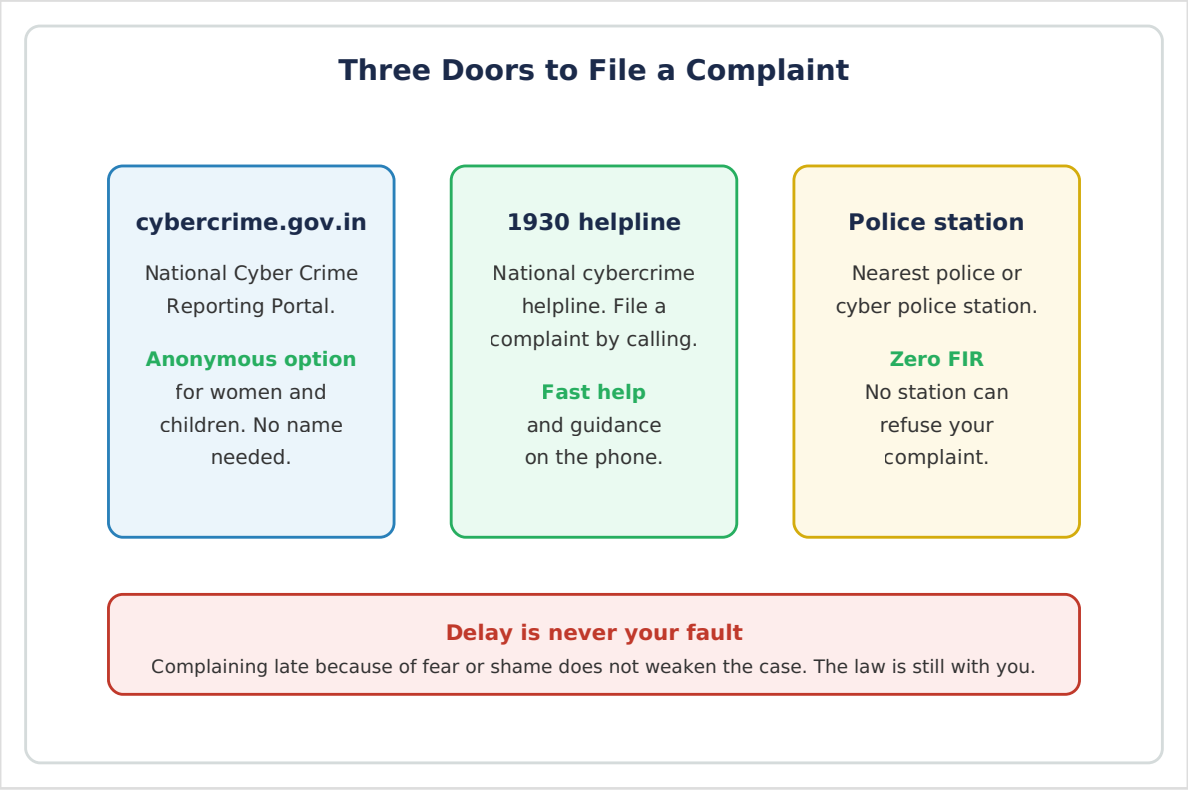
- No question should **cause her pain again** - let her speak at her pace, do not interrupt
- Say it in clear words: **it is not your fault** - the fault is the person who spread it
- Woman victim? Statement in a **woman officer's presence**, if she wants it
- Identity **completely secret** - and late complaint is **never** held against her

The Law in Simple Words

Match the facts to the section. Correct sections move the investigation; wrong ones invite attack:

- **66E:** capturing, making or sending private-moment images without permission - the privacy violation
- **67:** publishing or spreading obscene material electronically - the spreading itself
- **67A:** sexually explicit material electronically - **stricter**, years of jail plus heavy fine
- **BNS 77:** voyeurism - secretly watching or recording; **POCSO** applies if she is under 18 - the strictest law of all

Three Doors to File a Complaint



- Portal, helpline, station - **all three are real doors**
- Anonymous reporting exists so **fear never stops a complaint**
- Zero FIR: **no station can refuse**

cybercrime.gov.in: Step by Step

The Home Ministry's National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal - **know it cold**, so you can guide her on the phone:

- Two paths: **Report Women/Child Related Crime** (with anonymous option) and Report Other Cyber Crime
- Describe the incident **briefly, factually** - no unnecessary detail; suspect info optional
- Attach only **necessary** evidence files - hashed and recorded first (Lab 2's method)
- Anonymous path gives a **complaint number** - guard it; it tracks the whole case

1930 and Zero FIR

Two more safety nets - **no victim should ever hear 'go elsewhere'**:

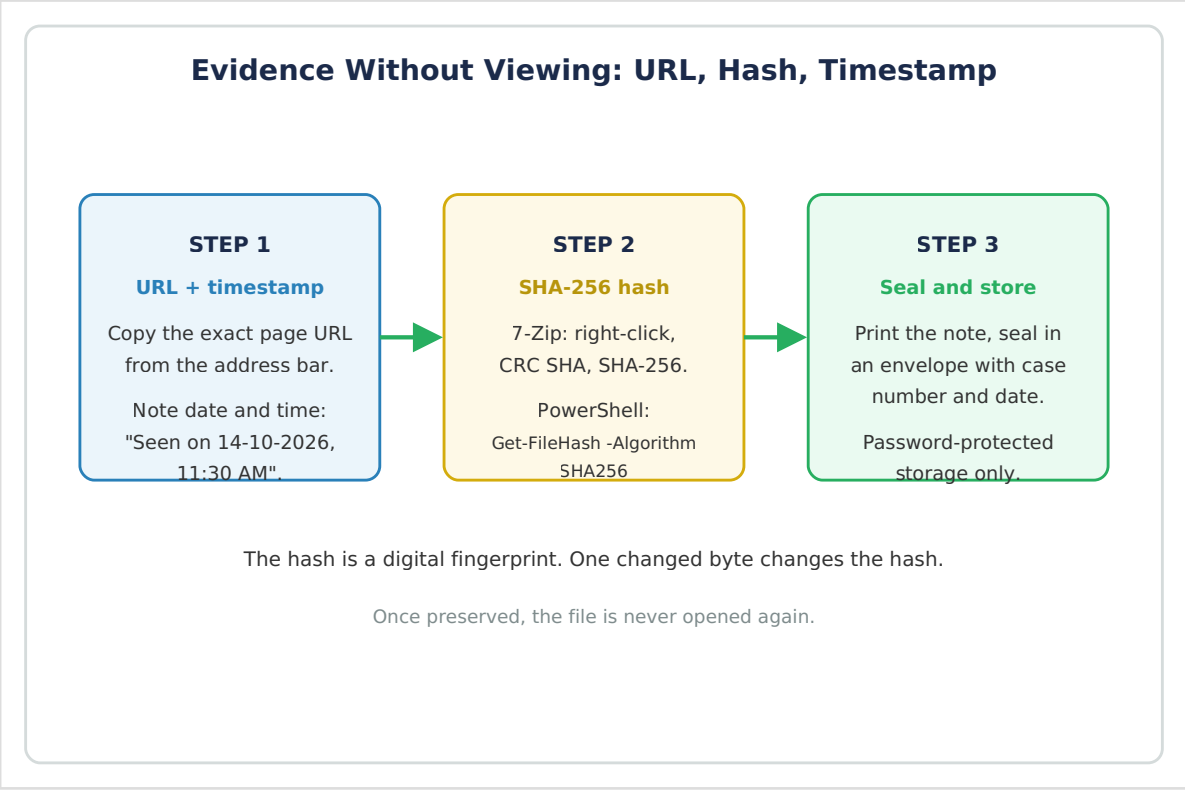
- **1930:** the national cybercrime helpline - complaint by phone, equally valid
- **Zero FIR:** register wherever she comes, transfer later - jurisdiction is the system's problem, not hers
- Portal down? OTP not coming? **1930, then the station** - the portal is a facility, not a compulsion
- Never file a **fictional test complaint** - it obstructs real victims and is legally wrong

How the Investigation Moves

Four steps, in order - **with her informed at every one**:

- **Preserve:** screenshots, links, chats secured fast - online content deletes easily; her dignity guarded throughout
- **Identify:** which account spread it, linked number or email - asked from the platform through **legal process only**
- **Remove:** grievance officer first, court order if needed - she should not suffer daily while the case runs
- **Arrest and charge sheet:** the accused faces the law - and she hears about **every step**

Evidence Without Viewing



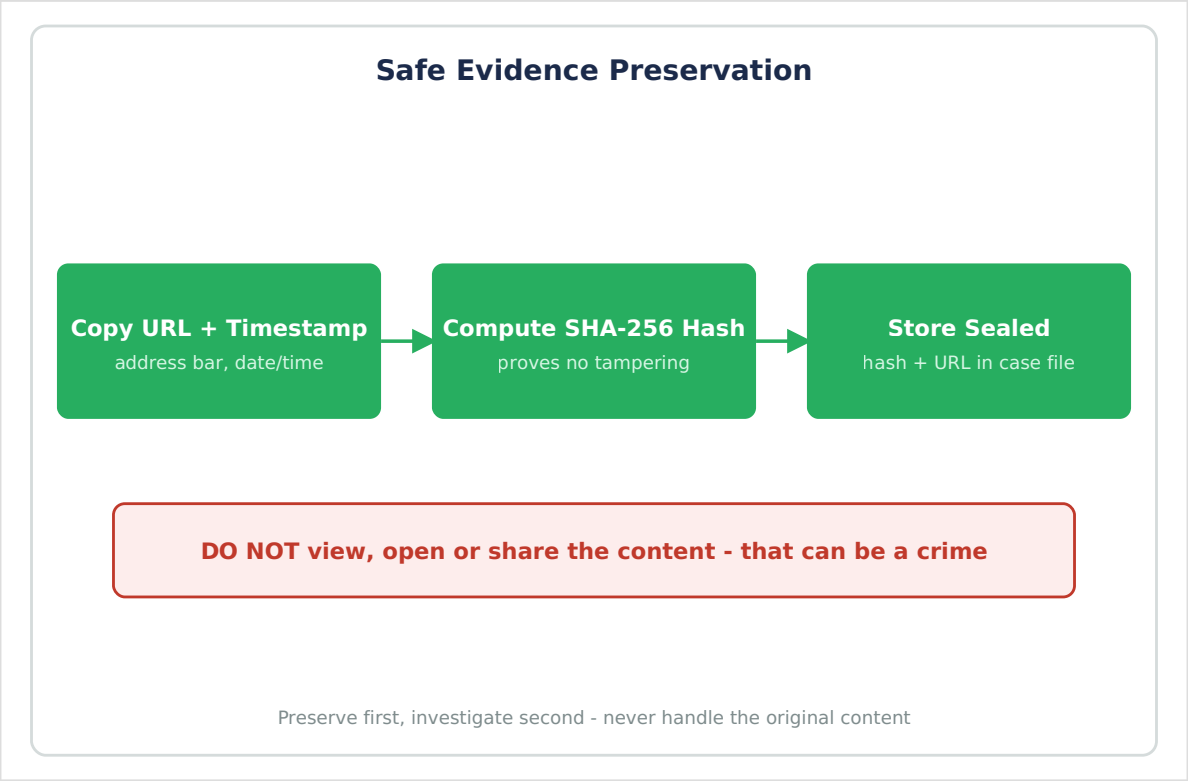
- URL, hash, timestamp - **the metadata is the evidence**
- 7-Zip or PowerShell: free, court-accepted hashing
- Once sealed, **never opened again**

Why You Never View or Forward



- Dignity, legal risk, purity - **three reasons, zero exceptions**
- 'For evidence' is **no defence** for spreading
- Official storage only - **never personal devices**

Safe Preservation in Practice



- Capture only what is needed - **no full-screen extras**
- File named with case number and date
- Access limited to the **authorised team**

Recording Her Statement Right

The statement founds the case. **Recorded wrong, she breaks; recorded right, the case stands.**

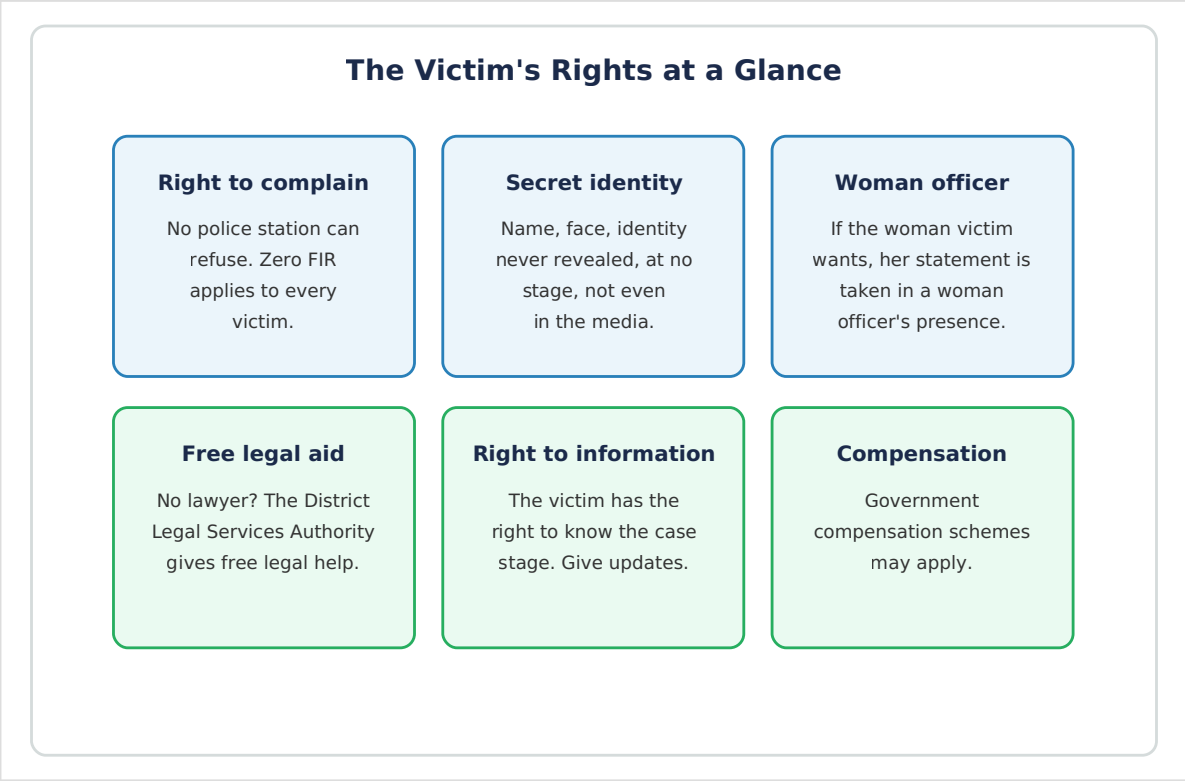
- **Place:** a quiet closed room - never a crowded desk; **pace:** hers - water and time if she cries
- **Questions:** short, one at a time, open-ended - 'what happened next' beats yes-or-no
- Write in **her words**, read it back, confirm - and honour the woman-officer rule
- **POCSO cases:** statement at home or a child-friendly place, trusted person present, never repeated questioning

Emotional Support Is Investigation

Shame and loneliness can break her **before the trial begins**. Support keeps her standing - and cooperating.

- Advise **counselling**; encourage one trusted family member - no one should carry this alone
- For parents: **hug first, listen fully** - do not snatch the phone or punish; he is already terrified
- Your support gives her courage - **courage gives you a witness**
- Threats to withdraw the complaint? That is **witness intimidation** - itself a crime. Preserve the threats

The Victim's Rights at a Glance



- Six rights - **inform her of all six**
- Rights told are rights used
- Your briefing is part of **her protection**

Platform Responsibility

The law does not leave her alone with the platform - **platforms have duties too**:

- IT Rules: big platforms must keep **grievance officers** and act on complaints in fixed time
- Illegal content reported must be **removed** - non-cooperating platforms face legal action
- Criminal abroad, server elsewhere? **International cooperation** - GDPR in Europe, online-safety laws in the US, UK, Australia
- Know the correct channel for each - **speed matters** when content spreads

Questioning the Accused - Professionally

Caught does not mean convicted. **Angry questioning harms the case** - professional questioning builds it:

- Stick to **facts**: accounts, devices, source of the content - every answer in writing
- Seize his device by **proper process** - it may hold her private content; examine only forensically, show no outsider
- Minor accused? **Separate legal rules** for interrogation and custody - follow them strictly
- Revenge has no place in an interrogation room - **the charge sheet does the talking**

Keeping Her Safe Afterwards

The FIR is filed - **her safety work continues**:

- Threats to take back the complaint: report **immediately**, preserve every threatening message - protection can be demanded
- Tighten social media **privacy settings** during the investigation; no unknown friend requests; no public phone or address
- Content reappears after removal? **Do not panic** - tell the investigator at once; re-uploading is also a crime
- Safety is not a one-day task - **check in regularly**

The Investigator's Own Self-Care

Hearing victims' pain daily **wears officers down**. A depleted investigator helps no one:

- Talk openly with your **senior** - being shaken by a case is not weakness
- Learn from **experienced officers**; divide the load so one person does not carry it all
- **Work-life balance:** files stay at the office; sleep is not optional
- Only a **healthy, balanced officer** can hold space for victims - care for yourself is part of the job

Mistakes That Cost Justice

Five errors that sink these cases:

- Treating her **delay** as doubt - fear and threats explain it; the law agrees
- Viewing or forwarding the content '**for the case**' - legally and ethically indefensible
- Discussing her story as **gossip** - a grave breach of trust
- Skipping the **removal process** - arrest without removal leaves her suffering daily
- Forgetting **POCSO's special rules** in child cases - procedure matters most where victims are youngest

Real Case: Operation Dignity - 13 Arrested

Manipur. Private videos and photos of local women - **including children** - sold for money through Telegram channels and WhatsApp groups.

- **One night, 13 arrested** including a minor; 14 phones and a laptop seized - IT Act, POCSO, BNS
- The network was **organised and profit-driven** - dignity monetised
- Police are still mapping the full network, money flows and more victims
- Source Hindustan Times
- Lesson: **one complaint plus proactive policing** can break a whole network

Real Case: AI-Made Fake Photos - Surat

Technology's new warning: the criminal **no longer needs a real photo**.

- Dindoli police arrested a 30-year-old woman for posting **AI-generated fake obscene photos** of her friend's fiancee and mother on Instagram
- After the engagement: unknown-account posts, abusive posts, then AI fakes from multiple accounts
- Case under **BNS and the IT Act** - fake or real, making and spreading it is equally a crime
- Source The Times of India

Your Turn: Labs in This Module

Three labs for the **most delicate work** you will do:

- **Lab 1:** Walk every stage of cybercrime.gov.in - know the portal like your own station
- **Lab 2:** The hash-and-timestamp method - 7-Zip and PowerShell, sealed-envelope discipline
- **Lab 3:** Draft the one-page victim support handout - helplines, next steps, courage in simple words
- Golden rule: **real numbers, real addresses only** - a wrong helpline number breaks trust

Key Takeaways

If you remember nothing else from Module 18:

- **Her dignity first** - always, in every line of the case
- **66E, 67, 67A, BNS 77, POCSO** - the legal toolkit, applied on facts
- Complaint has **three doors** - portal, 1930, station - plus Zero FIR
- **URL, hash, timestamp** - evidence without viewing, forwarding, or keeping
- Removal is **part of justice** - grievance officer to court order
- Support her **after** the FIR too - safety does not end at registration

Review Questions

- 1. A victim asks: 'Will my name appear anywhere?' Draft your complete answer - covering all six of her rights.
- 2. Explain the hash-and-timestamp method to a new constable in four steps. Why is each step necessary?
- 3. Give three reasons why forwarding the content 'for evidence' is wrong - one ethical, one legal, one technical.
- 4. A 15-year-old victim's case arrives. List every special rule that now applies, and why.
- 5. Design the one-page support handout: what five parts must it have, and in what language?

NEXT: MODULE 19

Surveillance and CCTV Investigation

The camera never blinks - learn to read what it saw

Cyber Crime Investigator - Training Manual